



Qualification Programme Examination Panelist's Report

Module 5 – Information Management (December 2021 Session)

(The main purpose of the following report is to summarise candidates' common weaknesses and make recommendations to help future candidates improve their performance in the examination.)

(I) Section A – Multiple Choice Questions

General Comments

This paper consisted of 20 multiple-choice (MC) questions. Candidates had to complete all the questions. The coverage of the questions was widely distributed among the topics of the syllabus as follows:

- (a) Analyse the role of e-Commerce;
- (b) Analyse the risks and security of information management;
- (c) Categorise the nature and account for the value of information systems;
- (d) Describe and apply corporate information systems;
- (e) Analyse systems development process; and
- (f) Use information technology applications.

The performance in MC questions was good, as these are usually short and straightforward questions.

Specific Comments

Candidates showed weaknesses in the following areas:

- (a) Analyse the risks and security of information management – apply the types of application controls;
- (b) Analyse systems development process – the behavioural issues of implementing information systems in entities;
- (c) Use information technology applications – the relationship between business intelligence (BI) systems and online analytical processing (OLAP); and
- (d) Use information technology applications – the steps in establishing a data warehouse.



(II) Section B – Written Questions

General Comments

Similar to the previous cohorts, most candidates performed well in some general and fundamental topics, such as areas of competitive advantages, duties and information needs of a production department, and the role of e-commerce in the Hong Kong business environment. However, many candidates performed weak in some specific IT topics, such as social engineering, management information systems (MIS), data analytics, cloud computing, and system development models in the system implementation stage.

Specific Comments

Question 1(a) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to define the term “social engineering”.

Performance was unsatisfactory. Many candidates failed to understand what social engineering is; some mentioned the usage of social media in marketing or customer communication.

Question 1(b) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate how attackers conduct social engineering attacks with examples.

The performance was unsatisfactory. Many candidates failed to understand what social engineering is. Instead, most of them discussed some general or common hacking attacks or computer attacks.

Question 1(c)(i), (ii) and (iii) – 3 Marks each, total 9 Marks

This question required candidates to analyse why the following measures could enhance the strength of password authentication:

- change password frequently;
- setup and apply account lockout threshold; and
- extend password length.

The performance was less than satisfactory. Some candidates were unable to discuss the reason or the purpose of setting these measures and how can these measures enhance the strength of password authentication. Some candidates briefly described each of these measures with an example.



Question 2(a) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to state and describe any three areas of competitive advantages.

The performance was good. However, some candidates mentioned offering low selling price to customers instead of maintaining cost leadership, and some of them mixed up the concepts of differentiation and innovation.

Question 2(b) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to categorise the three types of reports which can be generated by a management information system (MIS).

The performance was unsatisfactory. Many candidates provided the names of some general reports which could be generated by accounting systems whereas some of them categorised the MIS reports with the three management levels – strategic, tactical and operational.

Question 2(c) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate each type of MIS report with an example.

The performance was unsatisfactory as many candidates did not understand the three types of MIS reports. Marks were given to candidates if they could provide relevant examples of the three correct types of MIS reports.

Question 2(d) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to contrast the differences between predictive data analytics and prescriptive data analytics.

Performance was poor. Many candidates failed to understand these two types of data analytics. Some candidates mixed up the concepts of descriptive analytics and predictive analytics.

Question 3(a) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to summarise the primary and secondary activities under Porter's value chain model.

The performance was less than satisfactory. Some candidates provided irrelevant answer such as the duties and responsibilities between strategic and tactical level of management. A few candidates did not provide any answer for this part.



Question 3(b) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to outline any two primary duties and responsibilities of a production department and any two types of its information needs.

The performance was good. However, some candidates overlooked the second requirement of this question, and they did not provide any answer for information needs.

Question 3(c) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to classify and describe any three basic functions of a computer network.

The performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates could mention one of the correct functions only. Some candidates mentioned about data sharing and data storage, which are not the core functions of a computer network.

Question 3(d) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to list and describe the three common cloud deployment models.

Performance was poor. Many candidates mixed up the cloud service models, and the cloud deployment models. They seemed to think that these concepts are similar and these terms can be used interchangeably.

Question 3(e) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to list and describe the benefits of using cloud storage services.

The performance was satisfactory. However, some candidates did not provide sufficient or relevant description of the benefits.

Question 4(a) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to state and describe any two other software development models apart from the waterfall model.

Performance was poor. Many candidates failed to understand the other software development models and did not provide any answer for this part. Some candidates mentioned some of the phases of the systems development life cycle instead.



Question 4(b) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate any one essential feature and any one value adding feature of a packaged accounting software.

The performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates could only describe essential feature and value adding feature of a packaged accounting software. Some candidates demonstrated an essential feature as a value adding feature.

Question 4(c) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to list common sources of system change requests.

The performance was satisfactory. However, some candidates mentioned the general types of system users and their duties.

Question 5(a) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to state any four reasons why Hong Kong is perfectly suited and situated for e-commerce imports and exports.

The performance was good. Many candidates provided correct and relevant reasons.

Question 5(b)(i) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to justify the importance of managing customer expectations for reducing the possibility of receiving non-defect products from displeased customers.

The performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates emphasised the relationship between inaccurate product description and disappointment feelings of customers. However, a few candidates mentioned that the under-promise or over-deliver is a good idea to enhance customer satisfaction on the product received.

Question 5(b)(ii) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to justify the importance of providing training to customers for reducing the possibility of receiving non-defect products from displeased customers.

The performance was satisfactory.



Question 5(c) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to list the sequence of the six major steps under the knowledge management system cycle.

The performance was less than satisfactory. Some candidates were able to list some of the steps correctly. However, some candidates did not understand the steps and did not provide any answer for this part.

(III) Conclusion and Recommendation

Compared to the previous cohorts, the overall performance of the candidates in this examination was not satisfactory. In general, candidates performed poorly in relation to the syllabus areas of “Use information technology applications”, “Risks and security of information management” and “Analyse systems development process”. Candidates should spend more time and effort to become familiar with the topics in these three areas.

Candidates are reminded again to read the questions carefully and address what is being asked. Be careful to identify the keywords from each of the questions. In this examination, some candidates were not able to understand the requirement(s) of the verb “analyse” (in Question 1(c)) and “demonstrate” (in Question 4(b)), they just briefly described or explained the matters involved in these two parts without further elaboration. Candidates are advised to study the HKICPA Taxonomy and understand the requirements of different verbs when they are preparing for the examination.